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One Ring to find them...

Adidas has created a pair of 3D printed shoes made with plastic from Ocean Waste. <http://dgit.in/3DprintShoes>

Bazaar

YU Yutopia

Not quite the utopian wonder

There are few phones in the market that can come close to beating the OnePlus 2 when it comes to the performance to price factor and the YU Yutopia is one of them. The recently launched, self proclaimed, “most powerful smartphone ever”, has a Snapdragon 810 SoC and 4GB RAM, along with a 21MP rear camera, 5.2 inch QHD display and a fingerprint sensor on the back.

The Yutopia's is made completely out of metal, but it isn't the same build quality that you see on HTC and Apple phones. The metallic body feels good, but is prone to dents with the first fall. In addition, the Yutopia's design makes it bigger than it needs to be. While the phone has a 0.3 inch smaller display than the OnePlus 2, it's dimensions are almost the same. The Yutopia is wide, making it quite unwieldy, while the metal body is somewhat slippery as well. It's a good looking phone, but not one that's easy to manage with one hand.

The main issue with the Yutopia though is the buggy UI. Factory shipped software should never carry drastic bugs, but the Yutopia's software is riddled with bugs. At one point, our review unit developed an yellowish tint on the display after we used the Adaptive Display mode. It took a factory reset to solve the issue, leading us to re-download about 15 GB of music, apps and games. There were quite a few other noticeable bugs too, making the phone quite frustrating to use at time.

In addition, the software is also not as well optimised as the OnePlus 2. While the two phones may carry the same SoC, the Yutopia is not as powerful as the OnePlus 2 when it comes to graphics performance. Fro regular apps etc. though the phone is quite capable of handling them, albeit with bugs popping in here and there. Aggressive thermal control algorithms make the phone's performance in gaming and other such activities lesser than the OnePlus 2, but it's capable of keeping the Snapdragon 810 from heating up abnormally. The hero of the phone is the 21MP camera on the back, which



Price
₹24,999

though a tad slow to focus, takes really good images. The Yutopia's camera desaturates colours in some situations, but mostly takes really nice and sharp images. The camera is especially good at noise reduction in low light conditions and delivers quite bright images in such conditions.

Speaking of good things, the new AroundYu feature is well done. Yu has added a screen on the device, similar to Google Now, OnePlus' Shelf screen and HTC's Blinkfeed. Instead of showing contacts, social networks etc. however, this screen shows a collection of services, ranging from flight bookings to food, cabs and more. It's quite useful, but needs a lot of work from Yu, to take it to its full potential.

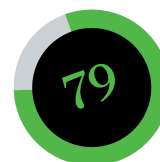
The 5.2 inch QHD display on the Yutopia gives it a big advantage over both the OnePlus 2 and Honor 7's display. Corning's Gorilla Glass makes the display really sharp and vivid, while also adding to the touch experience. The trade-off however is that the Yutopia's display is dim compared to flagship smartphones today.

The battery on the Yutopia is also at the industry average today. The phone can last a power user about 7-8 hours, while more basic users will be able to churn about 12 hours out of the battery.

Lastly, the Little Bird in-ear headphones from House of Marley, come out of the box with this smartphone. The headphones are quite bass heavy and don't do well with the mids and details. If you don't mind spending an extra ₹600, the Cowon EMIs can do a better job than the Little Birds.

Overall, the Yu Yutopia is definitely one of the better phones in the market today. That said, it's hard to recommend a phone that has so many bugs out of the box. If you're fine with trusting Yu to fix the bugs through OTA updates then the Yutopia isn't a bad buy at all, but while the OnePlus 2 is a more powerful device, the Honor 7 is comparable and much more stable. The Yu Yutopia is a good phone, but just like the OnePlus 2, it isn't a flagship killer.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5.2 inch QHD;
Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 810; **RAM:** 4GB;
Storage: 32GB, expandable to 128GB; **Camera:** 21MP rear, 8MP front; **Battery:** 3000 mAh

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